

Thursday, July 2, 2026

The Person I Almost Forgot



Some days don't introduce new people into your life.

They quietly reintroduce you to yourself.



2:08 AM — I finished all my tasks for the Day 18 refresher course. Now I have to wait until 7 AM without anything to do. This is going to be a long night.

A week ago, a stretch of empty hours like this would've been dangerous. It would've given my mind space to spiral, to reach for old conversations, to sit with thoughts I was trying to outrun.

Tonight, I'm just bored.

For the first time in a while, the silence wasn't painful. It was just... long.



3:37 AM — I finished all the episodes of the K-drama I was watching. That's the second K-drama I've completed since I started this journal. Still too long before 7 AM.

NoThingz is still playing in the background. At this point, I don't even choose it anymore. It has quietly become the soundtrack of these pages.



I spent the rest of the shift with GPT, brainstorming something I never expected to have — future Special Chapter titles. Chapters that won't exist for years, maybe longer. Chapters about who I'm becoming.

The Day I Stopped Looking Back.

The Version of Me I Was Waiting For.

The House That Learned Our Voices.

But one of them stopped me cold.

The Day It Stopped Being Ordinary.

I got goosebumps. I got a bit teary-eyed. I don't know why that one hit so hard. Maybe because I spent the first week of this journal learning how to enjoy ordinary days again. And now I was imagining a future where ordinary stops being ordinary — not because the days change, but because the people in them do.



7:00 AM — Shift over. I went to sleep.



11:12 AM — I woke up to unfamiliar voices. At first I thought someone had the TV on. Then I realized it was coming from outside my room. There was a woman talking, and when I stepped out, I saw a little girl I didn't recognize. Turns out they were visitors of my cousin's girlfriend.

I still don't know their names.

The first thing I noticed wasn't them. It was my stomach. I realized I never ate dinner. I actually forgot. Overnight shifts do that sometimes.



Before I even stood up, I opened Spotify. My fingers found the NoThingz playlist before my brain even thought about it. I laughed. My muscle memory already knows what my heart needs.



11:55 AM — The air fryer is taking its time. I'm standing here staring at it as though looking harder will somehow make it cook faster. It won't. I'm just hungry enough to believe it might.



Facebook reminded me that thirteen years ago, I was trying to learn BackTrack 5. I laughed. Back then, I thought I was just learning Linux. Looking back now, I think I was teaching myself not to be afraid of things I didn't understand.

That memory led to others.

I remembered being a math wizard in high school. Programming in Turbo C — readline, printline, ifs and else, cases. College — Electronics Engineering. Working at my uncle's company, self-studying AutoCAD, discovering Autodesk Inventor. Animation and Game Development — Unity, C#.

Sports too. Basketball. Badminton. Soccer. I used to play outside with my friends until the sun went down. There were no consoles or cellphones back then.

I kept remembering more. The guy who sang karaoke. The guy who played guitar. The guy who memorized every Adam Sandler movie.

I don't think these were separate versions of me. I think they were all the same person — just chapters I hadn't reread in years.



12:40 PM — Food's cooked. I made fried rice. I ate it watching 50 First Dates. Then I made coffee because it was getting dark. It looked like rain.

I've always loved that movie. Not just because it's funny. Because of the idea underneath it — every day is another chance to choose someone. When I'm with someone, I always liked making her fall in love with me every single day. Even without the memory loss.

Courting shouldn't stop when you decide to be together. It's not a quiz that you simply pass. It should be what maintains the relationship.



I was also thinking about something else while watching. What if I already know her now? What if she's someone I already talk to, someone whose name is already in my phone, and

we just haven't developed those feelings yet? A month ago, that thought would've terrified me. Today, it feels like quiet hope.



The rain started. I made another coffee.

The soundtrack of the movie shifted into Amber, then Underneath It All. I smiled. Then came Somewhere Over the Rainbow by Israel Kamakawiwo'ole. I got a little teary. Not because I was sad. Because somewhere in the middle of eating fried rice and watching Adam Sandler and listening to the rain, I realized the song didn't sound heartbreaking anymore.

It sounded hopeful.

The song didn't change. I did.



I caught myself singing under my breath — "I'll stop the world and melt with you." And I thought: how good it is to love again. Not because I found someone. Because it feels good knowing I still can. The door isn't locked anymore.

Your Universe by Rico Blanco came into my head. That line — "You can thank your stars all you want, but I'll always be the lucky one." I used to hear that as something I would say to someone else. Now it sounds like the kind of gratitude I want to feel when she's finally here.



4:38 PM — I started watching Duets. I really love how Gwyneth Paltrow sings. She doesn't sing like she's trying to overpower the song. She sings like she's telling a story. Cruisin' became my favorite. I sang that in a karaoke bar before.

I don't think I've sung karaoke in years. I used to love singing. That guy is still in here somewhere.



6:35 PM — Done with Duets.

I decided to watch a movie I hadn't seen in years. P.S. I Love You.



The Galway Girl played. I love the melody. I love the lyrics. "I lost my heart to that Galway girl." It doesn't sound like regret. It sounds like a memory worth keeping.



I had to pause the movie at 7:22 PM. I took a shower. A long hot one.

Nothing beats a long hot shower after a sleepless night.

Three hours before my next shift.



Finished the movie. Kinda bittersweet at the end.

Not heartbreaking. Not happy. Just true. It doesn't pretend healing means forgetting. It lets grief stay. But it refuses to let grief become the whole story.

And you know what I thought about after the credits rolled?

I think I'll play guitar again. I know how to play it. I just hadn't picked it up in years.



The last song of the night found me too. Glorious by Macklemore.

You know I'm back like I never left.

Another sprint, another step.

Another day, another breath.

I made it through the darkest part of the night.

And now I see the sunrise.

"It's who I am, how could I forget?"

That line stopped me. Because that's exactly what today was about. I almost forgot who I was — the math kid, the programmer, the athlete, the singer, the guitar player, the guy who still believes in courting someone every single day.

He never disappeared. I just hadn't visited him in a while.



I don't know if there's a single thing that happened today that would sound important if I wrote it down. I woke up. I ate. I watched movies. I remembered things. I made coffee because it was raining.

But somewhere between all those ordinary moments, I met someone I hadn't seen in years.

Me.



Today's Weight: 9/10

Not because it was happier than yesterday.

Because it was fuller.

Yesterday was hope.

Today was identity.

Songs of Day 9

- NoThingz — The Person I Could've Been
- NoThingz — Thank You for the Goodbye
- The Chainsmokers & Coldplay — Something Just Like This
- Israel Kamakawiwo'ole — Somewhere Over the Rainbow

- **Hugh Grant & Haley Bennett — Way Back Into Love**

- **Rico Blanco — Your Universe**

- **The Pogues — The Galway Girl**

- **Macklemore — Glorious**



On Day 1, I was writing to find out if I was still in there.

Today, I know I never left — I just hadn't visited myself in a while.

The tomorrow I thought would never come didn't announce itself with a revelation. It arrived as a Thursday —

old Facebook memories,

a guitar I hadn't touched in years,

rain that sounded different than it used to,

and the quiet realization that the person I almost forgot was never really gone.

He was just waiting for me to remember.

And somehow, remembering who I was — before the loss, before the doubt —

was exactly the reunion I didn't know I needed.



The night didn't need saving anymore.

— *Ralph.*

